

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Sometimes you just feel like throwing in the towel!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about feelings and reactions.
- I can show I understand someone's feelings or situation.
- I can explain my opinion about past events.

Ask your partner:

- Which situations do you usually find difficult? Why?
- What do you do to improve a difficult situation? Does it usually work?





Let's Explore!

Peter needs to **fine-tune*** his strategy. Can Sally help?

* When you "fine-tune" something, you make it better.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Hey Peter. Why do you look so dejected? Is anything wrong?
- Peter:** I just broke up with a girl I had met two weeks ago. She kept being late for our dates. I couldn't stand it.
- Sally:** You broke up for that? After only 2 weeks? I understand you might feel frustrated, but you may have made the wrong decision.
- Peter:** Do you think there's something wrong with me? I can't seem to find the right girl. It's really distressing.
- Sally:** The situation might look hopeless now, but there must be something you can do! I thought you had started going out to comic book stores before you met that girl. What happened? It sounded like a good idea.
- Peter:** It was, at first. Then I realized that the only girl who had gone there recently was Camilla.
- Sally:** Oh, I heard she has a boyfriend now. You must have been quite upset about that.
- Peter:** Thanks, Sally. You always know what to say to make situations worse!
- Sally:** Don't sound so despondent! Things will change, you'll see.
- Peter:** Well, I might just throw in the towel. What's the point anyway?
- Sally:** Hmm ... it sounds like you need some help. Let me take you for a drink. Maybe that could help you change your outlook on this. I had thought about going to the mall before you called me, but I think I'll go another day.
- Peter:** Thanks, Sally.





Let's Practice!

Peter can't seem to be able to *lift his spirits.

* "to lift the spirit up" means to change from sad to happy.

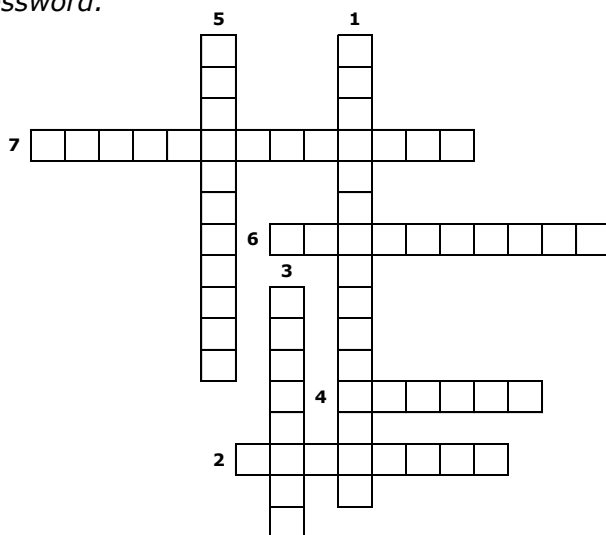
Instructions: Read the clues to complete the crossword.

Down

1. To quit or abandon something.
3. A desperate person with no hope.
5. A stressing situation that makes you anxious.

Across

2. Someone who is terribly sad or depressed.
4. A perspective you have about something.
6. You are tired of a situation.
7. You see no reason to continue.



Let's Practice!

Peter and Sally are talking about Peter's experience with Rosa.

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Why do you look so dejected? Is anything wrong?
2. I understand you might feel frustrated, but you may have made the wrong decision.
3. I can't seem to find the right girl. It's really distressing.
4. You must have been quite upset about that.
5. Well, I might just throw in the towel. What's the point anyway?





Extension Activity

Create a fake dating profile.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine that you will be joining an online dating service.
- Create a profile. Include a description of yourself (e.g. age, height, etc.).
- Include a few sentences about yourself and what you are looking for.
- Include a few sentences about your past experiences.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I describe myself.

☐ ☐

I describe what I am interested in and what interests me.

☐ ☐

I describe my past experiences.

☐ ☐

Target Words

- **to throw in the towel** (expression): to quit or abandon something
e.g. Well, I might just throw in the towel. What's the point anyway?
- **dejected** (adjective): terribly sad or depressed
e.g. Why do you look so dejected? Is anything wrong?
- **despondent** (adjective): feeling very sad and depressed
e.g. Don't sound so despondent! Things will change.
- **distressing** (adjective): causing someone to feel anxious, stressed or suffering
e.g. I can't seem to find the right girl. It's really distressing.
- **hopeless** (adjective): desperate and with no hope
e.g. It might look hopeless now, but there must be something you can do!
- **What's the point?** (expression): used to express hopelessness and impossibility when facing certain situation
e.g. I'm quitting! What's the point anyway?
- **outlook** (noun): perspective you have on something
e.g. Maybe that could help you change your outlook on this.





Learning Points

Expressing Understanding Using Modals

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

You **must have** been quite upset about that.

Must = it's very likely

Must not / Could not / Can't = it's not possible

May / Might / Can / Could = it's possible

May not / Might not = it's possible this is not true

Modal	Meaning
<i>There must be something you can do!</i>	It's very likely there is something you can do.
<i>I can't seem to find the right girl.</i>	It's not possible to find the right girl.
<i>You may have made the wrong decision.</i>	It's possible that you made the wrong decision.

Examples:

- *I understand you might feel frustrated, but you may have made the wrong decision.*
- *Maybe that could help you change your outlook on this.*





Learning Points

Expressing an Opinion About Past Events (Simple Past vs Past Perfect)

You use the Past Perfect tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

You use the Simple Past to talk about a finished action that happened at a specific time in the past.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:

Subject + had + past participle

*I **had thought** about going to the mall before you called me*

Which event happened *first*? I thought about going to the mall.

Which event happened *later*? You called me.

You use the Past Perfect tense (not Simple Past) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

Example:

*I just broke up with a girl I **had met** two weeks ago.*

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about the action that happened after that prior action in the Past Perfect tense.

Examples:

- *I thought you had started going out to comic book stores before you met that girl.*
- *What happened? It sounded like a good idea.*

